CODEBOOK – CONTENT DIVERSITY IN NEWS ABOUT IMMIGRATION

Should you have any questions regarding the codebook and/or coding process, please contact Elif Kılık (elif.kilik@uantwerpen.be).

Project Description

This project investigates the content diversity of news coverage around immigration in five countries: Belgium, Ireland, The Netherlands, The UK and Turkey. This codebook provides instructions in English for the coding of news articles from the UK and Ireland.

Content diversity is evaluated in terms of the variety of issue subdimensions and news actors represented in the news coverage of immigration. The analysis covers articles in the period of one year prior to the last general elections held in the country (in 2023/2024).

Selection of the Articles for Coding

The news articles were collected from NexisUni and if not available, from the websites of the news organizations. Articles are selected based on country specific and general keywords of immigration coverage.

Access to Material and Coding Tool

The coders will be provided with the coding material collected by the researcher. The coding will be done online using Qualtrics tool. Coders can access the coding page using the link provided in the coding instructions below.

General coding rules

Consider only the textual information (title, subtitles and text) of the news article when coding, disregard any photographs or videos, and captions belonging to photographs or videos that may be placed in the article. When coding, make your decisions based on the information provided in the news article and asked by the codebook, and not your own prior knowledge or interpretations, assumed consequences or any associations that you may infer, or links to other articles. In doubt, e-mail the researcher of the project using the address provided above.

Use of Generative AI is strictly prohibited. The use of Generative AI tools such as ChatGPT, Claude, or other language models for any coding purposes is completely forbidden. This study aims to test these models' capabilities, and the use of AI models for manual human annotations would compromise the validity and reliability of the research findings.

For each article, start by reading the article completely at least once before you code any variables. While coding, it is important to always have this codebook at hand for reference. Despite the fact that we often think we know the variables well, coding can be intensive provess and sometimes the details can be forgotten. Therefore, make sure your codebook is always open during the coding process.

Coding Instructions & Variable Descriptions

For each news article you code, go to the following Qualtrics link **for the variables M1, M2, M3, M4, V1 and V2:** https://uantwerpen.eu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_837lmiyOUrCGk2a

Section 1: Metadata

M1. Coder: Select your name from the dropdown list of coders.
M2. Article ID: Copy and paste the article ID provided in the article Word document.
M3. Article Title: Copy and paste the article title provided in the article Word document.
M4. Country: Please select the country of the news outlet provided in the article Word document.

Section 2: Article Topic

V1. Main Topic of the News Article

Does the article mainly focus on the topic immigration?

- Yes
- No

This variable is a filter variable to exclude articles that are not about immigration from further analyses. An article can only be considered mainly about immigration if the majority of its coverage focuses on immigration or immigrant groups (including immigrants, asylum seekers, refugees, resettlers, other migrants such as expats, international students, foreign workers, seasonal workers). To determine this, check the word count of the parts discussing immigration. Consider the complete article text as context unit. If immigration-related content comprises at least half of the article, code this variable as Yes. If immigration-related content comprises approximately the half of discussion, consider the title and article framing to decide whether the discussion around immigration is sufficient to be considered as the main topic of the article. If immigration is one of two central, equally developed themes, it

still counts as immigration coverage. The key test is: Remove the immigration context - does the core story still exist? Then the article is not mainly about immigration.

Immigration is a multidimensional issue encompassing discussions about:

- Immigration and immigrant groups (asylum seekers, refugees, expats, international students, foreign workers, seasonal workers) and their experiences with migration, immigration processes and integration into host countries,
- Private stories and lived experiences of immigrants and their families, including personal challenges, challenges during migration, adaptation, integration, work and community life in the host country,
- Immigration related policy and societal topics such as migration flows, border controls, deportations, labor migration, visas/residence permits/naturalization/resettlement, housing and accommodation of immigrants, and social integration programs.
- Illegal immigration including unauthorized border crossings, people smuggling networks and organized criminal activities related to immigration, misconduct or criminal cases involving immigration processes,
- The economic/financial and social impacts of immigration on both origin and destination countries,
- Political discussions, legislations and campaign rhetoric related to immigration policies and/or immigrant groups,
- Public opinion about immigration and immigrants,
- Bileteral agreements, international treaties, and EU regulations (if applicable) governing immigration and mobility.

However, brief references to immigration/immigrant groups as context for discussing other issues as main topic (e.g., anti-Muslim sentiment, religious intolerance, racism, or ethnic discrimination, crime stories where the perpetrator or the victim is an immigrant with no further discussion on immigration or immigrant groups), discussions around *emigration* (the departure of citizens/professionals from the country of newspaper abroad) or migration within country and discussions around short-term travel or visas (e.g., Schengen tourist visas, 90-day stays, holiday travel) do not count as coverage of the issue of immigration unless the coverage of such issues is directly linked and discussed in relation to immigration or immigrant groups in the larger portion of the article text.

V2. Relevance to the Country of the News Outlet

Is the immigration-related discussion in this article about or relevant to the country of the news outlet?

- Yes
- No

When coding this variable, consider only the parts of the article about immigration as the context unit and ignore the rest of the article. This variable is another filter variable for including only immigration news coverage relevant to the country of the news outlet (as coded in variable M4 described above).

Code this variable as **Yes** if the article discusses:

- General discussions on immigration, migration, immigrant groups without specific reference to any country.
- Immigration/asylum/integration directly affecting the country of the news outlet.
- Immigration policies or regulations that apply to the country of the news outlet (e.g., EU/EEA regulations for EU member states).
- Immigration flows or situations in neighboring or key origin/transit countries that impact the immigration context/discussions in the country of the news outlet.
- Immigration discussions in other countries such as key origin/transit countries that are linked/presented in comparison/relation to the country of the news outlet.
- Bilateral or multilateral agreements related to immigration involving the country of the news outlet.
- Immigration-related events or developments in other countries that have direct implications for immigration policy or public debate of the country of the news outlet.

Code this variable as **No** if the article discusses:

- Immigration issues in distant countries to the country of the news outlet.
- Immigration issues in countries with no clear connection to the country of the news outlet.
- Immigration stories or policies that do not impact or relate to the context of the country of the news outlet.

Section 3: News Actors

Use the following link for coding actors:
https://uantwerpen.eu.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_cOOj3abnf8c6MoC

A news actor is a person (including people and a group of individuals) or an organization that is quoted or paraphrased in the news article. An actor acts as a source of information/opinion through the quotations or paraphrased statements. Therefore, mentions of a person (including people and a group of individuals) or an organization is not sufficient to count them as a news actor, they should be quoted or paraphrased to be coded as a news actor.

News actors can be either named entities (specific individuals or organizations with proper names) or unnamed individuals/groups/organizations (collective or generic references to entities without specific identification such as *the government*, *workers, students, immigrants, residents, protesters, officials, experts, sources, doctors, asylum seekers, young people, elderly residents).* The unnamed entities can therefore be considered as news actors if they are quoted or paraphrased. Geopolitical locations such as countries, cities, municipalities can be quoted/paraphrased in the news article to refer to the government/administration statements Therefore, if quoted/paraphrased, locations can be annotated as news actors as well.

In the following example Germany should be coded as the news actor, even though the article refers to the government of Germany not the geopolitical location:

- *Germany claimed that the new EU deal will not help Ukranian asylum seekers fleeing Russian aggression.*

Organizations as news actors can be quoted/paraphrased directly or through people who are representatives/spokespeople of the organization. If representatives are quoted/paraphrased, they should be coded as news actors.

A **direct quotation** presents statements attributed to a source (news actor) enclosed in quotation marks.
Examples:

- *Johnson said, "The policy will help reducing immigration by 50%."*

An **indirect quotation/paraphrased statement** presents statements from a source (news actor) without quotation marks, in journalists' own words with clear attribution to the source. Examples:

- *According to Johnson, the new policy will help reducing immigration by 50%.*
- *Johnson said that the policy would reduce immigration by 50%.*

A person/organization qualifies as a news actor only if their words, ideas, or positions are presented with explicit attribution to them indicating the journalist is conveying what the source communicated. Communication can be a verbal communication from the actor directly or written statement from a published document/press release, etc. For example, the company is a news actor in the following sentence:

- *The company's annual report, published last week, states the increase reflects the growth in the number of migrants.*

Attribution can be done using attribution cue verbs such as: said, stated, argued, claimed, explained, noted or phrases such as "according to (name of the actor)", "(name of the actor) told reporters". To make sure, you can test this by adding "according to (name of the actor)" to the beginning of the statement. If this can be done without changing the meaning then the actor can be coded as a news actor. If not, the statement might be journalists' own characterizations/interpretations, and should not be coded as news actor, as the journalist (the author) of the article is not considered as news actor. In the following example police is not a news actor because there is no statement quoted/paraphrased from the police:

- *Since the attack on Wednesday night, police have revealed more information*

On the other hand the Catholic Church should be coded as news actor in the following sentence:

- *The Catholic Church in the North East confirmed he was part of a justice and peace charitable project.*

As we can use the test and give the same information without changing the meaning:

- *According to the Catholic Church, he was part of a justice and peace charitable project.*

Finally, **a news actor is coded once per article**, combine all mentions, quotations or paraphrased statements from the same actor when coding variables for this actor.

V3. Actor Name/Description

Please copy-paste the name of the actor as described in the news article. If the name of the news actor is not available, copy-paste how the news actor is identified in the article, using the primary descriptor the journalist uses to introduce or refer to them. Do not add information from your own knowledge or external sources.

Named actors: Copy the exact name/title as it appears: "Prime Minister Johnson", "Dr. Smith," "Mayor Garcia". If multiple versions of the name/description to the same actor appear (e.g., "Secretary of State Blinken" then later "Blinken"), use the most complete version provided in the article, typically from the first mention. If the first and last name of individuals is provided in the article, please only use the first and last name.
For unnamed actors (actors with generic names): Copy the exact description: "local residents", "immigration officials", "protesters", "the government", "workers at the plant". Use the most specific descriptor provided in the article. If multiple descriptors exist, use the most detailed one.

Do not supplement with external knowledge (even if you know the person's full name) or abbreviate what the article provides in full.

Examples:

- If article says "Prime Minister Sunak" → Code: "Prime Minister Sunak"
- If article says "Prime Minister Sunak" → Don't code: "Rishi Sunak" (adding first name from your knowledge)
- If article says "the mayor" → Code: "the mayor"

V4. Actor Function

This variable measures the function of the news actor within the context of their quoted/paraphrased statements in the article. Function refers to the occupation or role of the actor within a certain situation presented in the article when quoting/paraphrasing the actor. Therefore, the purpose of the variable is the most correct estimation of the role in which the actor gives a quote/paraphrased statement.

An actor can sometimes have multiple functions within the same article, for instance an immigrant can be quoted/paraphrased to describe their journey to the host country and their

occupation (doctor) might be mentioned. However, if the person is quoted/paraphrased as an immigrant about their immigration process, then the function would be category 4 (members of public). If the person was quoted/paraphrased about their experiences as a doctor or their medical expertise then the correct function would be category 2 (professionals and experts). If quoted about both topics equally: Code based on the dominant theme of their statements or the primary reason they were selected as a source of information. Therefore, the function that is most applicable within the context of actors' statements should be coded. Based on the information provided in the article about the news actor, choose the function category that best fits the actor:

1. Government and politics (includes international, national, regional politicians, government/state officials, members/organizations of law enforcement, judiciary and military)
2. Professionals and experts (experts outside government/state organizations, media and businesses and business representatives, researchers, lawyers, academics, celebrities)
3. Civil society organizations (non-governmental organizations, grasroots organizations, non-profit organizations, trade unions, activist organizations, interest groups, think thanks, minority/migrant organizations and other types of civil society organizations and their members)
4. Citizens/members of the public (ordinary citizens, residents, people speaking from personal experience rather than professional expertise such as residents affected by policies, immigrants sharing personal stories, eyewitnesses to events, community members expressing individual opinions, individual protesters/activists)

V5. Actor Political Party

This variable asks about the political party of the actor if the actor has a political function and the party they belong to is mentioned in the news article (and therefore in V4. Actor Function the option 1 is selected).

A political party can be mentioned in its full name or abbreviation in a news article. Please **copy-paste the exact reference to the party name** from the news article and avoid writing the name of the party yourself. If the party name is mentioned in its full name and abbreviation, copy-paste only the full name of the political party. **Do not** add information from your own knowledge or external sources even if you know/find out the party of the actor if it is not mentioned in the news article.